INTERNAL GUIDANCE

Digital Services Act – Article 27: Recommender System Transparency
Document ID: IG-DSA-027
Department: Regulations
Audience: Product, Engineering, Data Science, Legal and Trust & Safety
Status: Draft for internal review
Review frequency: At least annually and when relevant regulatory or product changes occur.

1. Purpose

This guidance explains the operational requirements associated with **Article 27** of the EU Digital Services Act (DSA).

The objective is to ensure that users understand how the platform's recommender systems influence the information presented to them and what options are available to modify those recommendations.

2. Regulatory requirement

Article 27 applies to providers of online platforms that use recommender systems.

The platform must:

- Explain the main parameters used by its recommender systems in its terms and conditions.
- Explain the most significant criteria determining the information recommended to users.
- Explain why those criteria have their respective levels of importance.
- Describe the options available to users to modify or influence those parameters.
- Where multiple ranking options are available, provide a functionality allowing users to select and modify their preferred option at any time, directly and easily accessible from the relevant interface.

3. Internal operational requirements

Requirement	Proposed implementation	Responsible team
Identify recommender systems	Maintain an inventory of recommendation features.	Product
Document ranking criteria	Record the main factors influencing recommendations and their relative importance.	Data Science
Review user disclosures	Ensure explanations are clear and understandable.	Legal / T&S
Provide user controls	Implement accessible recommendation preferences where required.	Product / Engineering
Verify implementation	Test that the documented controls function as intended.	Engineering / Compliance
Maintain evidence	Retain technical documentation, approvals and testing records.	Compliance

4. Evidence and documentation

The following evidence should be retained:

1. Recommender-system inventory.
2. Technical description of the main ranking parameters.
3. Legal review of the relevant terms and conditions.
4. Screenshots of user-facing explanations and preference controls.
5. Testing records demonstrating that user selections work.
6. Product approval and implementation records.

5. Escalation and change management

Any material change to recommendation logic, ranking parameters or available user controls should be referred to the Regulations Dept. team.

The team should determine whether the change requires:

- Updated regulatory analysis.
- Revised user-facing disclosures.
- Product or engineering changes.
- Additional testing or approval.
- An updated implementation record.

For services within scope of the UK Online Safety Act, the relevant teams should also determine whether the change requires an updated illegal-content or children's risk assessment.

6. Important distinction

Article 27 establishes general recommender-system transparency requirements for covered online platforms. Article 38 introduces an additional non-profiling option for very large online platforms and search engines.

The requirements should not be confused.

7. Ownership and review

Regulations Dept. maintains this guidance and coordinates updates. Legal remains responsible for confirming the interpretation and applicability of the legislation. Product, Engineering and Data Science remain responsible for implementing and maintaining the relevant controls.